

Shift Espresso x FlowDesk

Installation Day Guide

A detailed reference guide for setting up Daniel's live WhatsApp Business system. Use this if you get stuck or need to retrace steps.

Prepared for Meir | June 2026

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1. Pre-Installation Checklist

Before leaving for the restaurant, confirm you have everything.

What Daniel needs to have ready:

- His personal Facebook account (email + password)
- The phone number for WhatsApp (SIM activated, receiving SMS)
- The phone number must NOT be registered on WhatsApp or WhatsApp Business app
- His email address for FlowDesk login
- A business document for Meta verification (registration certificate, utility bill, or bank statement showing business name and address)

What you need:

- Your MacBook with Chrome browser
- This guide (printed or on a second device)
- The installation checklist (printed)
- Access to the Freelancer chat thread with the developer

How to check if the phone number is on WhatsApp:

Open WhatsApp on any phone. Add the number as a contact. If it shows a WhatsApp profile picture or status, the number is registered. If it shows nothing, it's clean and ready to use.

WARNING: If the number IS registered on WhatsApp, it must be deleted from the app first. Open WhatsApp on that phone > Settings > Account > Delete my account. Wait 5 minutes before proceeding.

Setting up the browser:

On your MacBook, open Chrome. Click your profile icon (top right) > Add > create a new profile called 'Daniel Shift Espresso'. This keeps Daniel's login separate from yours. Daniel enters his Facebook credentials in this profile.

2. Creating Daniel's Meta Business Portfolio

This is the container that holds all of Daniel's business assets (Facebook Page, WhatsApp, etc).

Step by step:

1. In the Daniel browser profile, go to: business.facebook.com
2. Daniel logs in with his personal Facebook account
3. Click 'Create account' or 'Create a Business Portfolio'
4. Business name: Enter Daniel's business name (e.g. 'Shift Espresso Silvamonte' or his registered franchise name)
5. Your name: Daniel's name
6. Business email: Daniel's email
7. Click 'Submit'
8. You'll land on the Meta Business Suite dashboard

TIP: Write down the Business Portfolio ID. You can find it in the URL bar or under Settings > Business Info. It looks like a long number.

IMPORTANT: This creates a new, separate Business Portfolio owned by Daniel. Do NOT use the Big Brain AI portfolio.

If Daniel already has a Meta Business account:

If Daniel already has a Meta Business Portfolio (from the franchise or previous setup), you can use that instead. Just make sure he has admin access. Go to Settings > Business Info and note the Business Portfolio ID.

3. Creating the Facebook Page

A Facebook Page is required to create a WABA. It represents the business on Facebook.

If Shift Espresso already has a Facebook Page:

Check if Daniel has access to it. Go to the page > Settings > Page Access. If it's managed by another Business Portfolio (e.g. the franchise head office), you may need to create a new one for his branch.

Creating a new page:

1. In Meta Business Suite, go to the left sidebar > Pages
2. Click 'Add' > 'Create a new Page'
3. Page name: 'Shift Espresso Silvamonte' (or similar branch-specific name)
4. Category: 'Coffee Shop' or 'Cafe'
5. Add a brief description if you want, or skip for now

6. Click 'Create Page'

TIP: The page can be basic for now. It just needs to exist for the WABA. Daniel can add photos and content later.

4. Creating the WABA (WhatsApp Business Account)

The WABA is the WhatsApp Business Account that will hold Daniel's phone number and handle all messaging.

1. In Meta Business Suite, go to Settings (gear icon, bottom left)
2. In the left sidebar under 'Accounts', click 'WhatsApp accounts'
3. Click 'Add' (top right)
4. Choose 'Create a WhatsApp Business Account'
5. Account name: 'Shift Espresso'
6. Select the Facebook Page you just created
7. Time zone: Africa/Johannesburg
8. Currency: ZAR (South African Rand)
9. Accept the WhatsApp Business terms
10. Click 'Create'

TIP: Note the WABA ID -- you'll find it in the URL or the account details. It's a long number starting with a digit.

If you see an error about the Facebook Page:

Make sure the page is in Daniel's Business Portfolio and not claimed by another portfolio. Go to Pages > check the page status.

5. Adding the Phone Number

This connects Daniel's phone number to the WhatsApp Cloud API.

1. Go to WhatsApp Manager (search for it in Meta Business Suite, or go to business.facebook.com/latest/whatsapp_manager/)
2. Make sure the correct WABA is selected (top right dropdown)
3. Click 'Phone numbers' in the left sidebar under 'Account tools'
4. Click 'Add phone number' (blue button, top right)
5. Enter the phone number with country code (e.g. +27 81 321 6736)
6. Choose a display name: 'Shift Espresso Silvamonte'
7. Category: Choose the most appropriate one
8. Click 'Next'
9. Choose verification method: SMS (recommended)

10. Daniel receives an OTP on his phone -- he reads it out to you

11. Enter the OTP code

12. Click 'Verify'

TIP: After verification, note the Phone Number ID. Click on the phone number in WhatsApp Manager and you'll see the ID in the details or URL.

WARNING: Once verified, this number is removed from the WhatsApp/WhatsApp Business app permanently. It can ONLY be used through the API (FlowDesk).

If OTP doesn't arrive:

Wait 60 seconds. Try again with 'Voice call' instead of SMS. Make sure the phone has signal. If the number is on a new SIM, try making a test call to confirm it's active.

6. Creating the Meta App

The Meta App is the technical bridge between WhatsApp and FlowDesk.

1. Go to: developers.facebook.com
2. Log in with Daniel's Facebook account (same browser profile)
3. Click 'My Apps' (top right) > 'Create App'
4. Choose app type: 'Business'
5. App name: 'Shift Espresso FlowDesk' (or similar)
6. Contact email: Daniel's email
7. Business Portfolio: Select Daniel's Business Portfolio
8. Click 'Create App'
9. On the next screen, find 'WhatsApp' and click 'Set up'
10. Select Daniel's WABA when prompted

TIP: Note the App ID from the dashboard. You'll need it for webhook configuration if asked.

If developers.facebook.com asks for additional verification:

Sometimes Facebook asks you to verify your developer account. Follow the prompts -- it usually just requires confirming your phone number or email.

7. Creating the System User and Token

The System User generates a permanent access token that FlowDesk uses to send and receive messages on behalf of Daniel's business.

1. Go to Meta Business Suite > Settings
2. Left sidebar > Users > System Users
3. Click 'Add' (top right)
4. System user name: 'FlowDesk'
5. System user role: 'Admin'
6. Click 'Create System User'
7. Now click 'Add Assets' next to the new system user
8. Select 'Apps' > find the app you created > toggle 'Full control'
9. Select 'WhatsApp accounts' > find the WABA > toggle 'Full control'
10. Click 'Save Changes'
11. Now click 'Generate new token'

12. Select the App you created

13. Select these permissions:

- whatsapp_business_management
- whatsapp_business_messaging

14. Click 'Generate Token'

15. COPY THE TOKEN IMMEDIATELY and save it somewhere safe (notes app, message to yourself)

WARNING: You can ONLY see the token once. If you close the dialog without copying it, you'll need to generate a new one. Copy it to a notes app, text file, or message it to yourself immediately.

8. Adding You as Admin

This gives you ongoing access to support and configure Daniel's setup without owning his assets.

1. In Meta Business Suite > Settings > Users > People
2. Click 'Add People'
3. Enter your email address (the one linked to your Facebook/Meta account)
4. Select role: 'Admin'
5. Click 'Next' and assign access to all assets (WABA, Page, App)
6. Click 'Send Invitation'
7. Accept the invitation from your own Meta Business account

9. Sending Credentials to Developer

Send these 4 values to the developer via the Freelancer chat:

- 1. Phone Number ID:** Found in WhatsApp Manager > Phone Numbers > click the number > see the ID in the details or URL
- 2. WABA ID:** Found in WhatsApp Manager > Overview or in the URL
- 3. Permanent Access Token:** The token you copied from the System User step
- 4. Daniel's email:** For his FlowDesk login account

The developer will configure FlowDesk and respond with a confirmation once connected. This takes about 5-10 minutes.

10. Business Verification

This is optional for go-live but recommended. Without verification, you're limited to 250 business-initiated conversations per 24 hours. This is fine for the first few weeks.

1. In Meta Business Suite > Settings > Business Info
2. Find 'Business verification status' > click 'Start verification'
3. Upload a business document: utility bill, bank statement, or business registration certificate showing the business name and address
4. Submit and wait 1-7 business days
5. Once verified, the 250 conversation limit is removed

TIP: You can start this process on installation day. It runs in the background and doesn't block going live.

11. Post-Installation Testing

After the developer confirms FlowDesk is connected, test these flows:

Test 1: Incoming message

Send a WhatsApp message from any phone to the new number. It should appear in FlowDesk Inbox within a few seconds. The AI should auto-reply.

Test 2: Staff reply

Reply to the message from FlowDesk Inbox. The customer should receive it on WhatsApp.

Test 3: Loyalty QR

Scan the loyalty counter display QR. It should open WhatsApp with the loyalty join message. The bot should ask for name and email, then enrol.

Test 4: Order QR

Scan the ordering counter display QR. It should open WhatsApp with the order message. Try ordering '1 cappuccino'. The bot should show a price summary.

Test 5: Stamp

From FlowDesk Inbox or Orders, click +1 Stamp. The customer should receive a WhatsApp stamp confirmation.

Test 6: Campaign

Create a test campaign and send it. Check that it appears in the customer's inbox as an orange 'Campaign message'.

12. Troubleshooting Common Issues

Messages not sending from FlowDesk:

Check that the access token is correct. Check that the Phone Number ID matches. Ask the developer to check the server logs.

Messages not arriving in FlowDesk:

The webhook might not be configured. Ask the developer to verify the webhook subscription. The webhook URL should be pointed to the FlowDesk server.

OTP not arriving during number verification:

Wait 60 seconds and try again. Try voice call instead of SMS. Confirm the SIM is active by making a normal phone call.

'Display name not approved' error:

Meta reviews display names. Avoid generic names. Use the actual business name. Try 'Shift Espresso' or 'Shift Espresso Silvamonte'. It may take a few minutes to approve.

Token generation fails:

Make sure the System User has the correct assets assigned (App + WABA). Make sure you selected the right permissions (whatsapp_business_management + whatsapp_business_messaging).

WABA creation fails:

Make sure the Facebook Page is in Daniel's Business Portfolio. Make sure the page isn't already linked to another WABA.

Fallback plan:

If anything goes seriously wrong, Daniel's existing WhatsApp is untouched (we're using a separate number). The developer can debug remotely via server logs. Nothing is lost.

13. Key IDs and Credentials Reference

Fill in these values as you go through the setup. Keep this page safe.

Item	Value
Daniel's Facebook email	
Daniel's FlowDesk email	
Business Portfolio ID	
Facebook Page name	
WABA ID	
WABA name	
Phone Number	
Phone Number ID	
Meta App ID	
Meta App name	
System User name	
Access Token (first 20 chars)	
Webhook URL	flowdesk.simplytranscriptions.co.za/api/webhook
Developer contact	Freelancer chat thread